

Glossary: Social Interaction

Social Interaction

The way people communicate, behave, and respond to each other in everyday life.

Example: Talking with friends, working in a team, or chatting online.

Social Technologies

Digital tools that help people communicate and interact with others.

Example: WhatsApp, Zoom, Google Docs.

Social Media

Online platforms where people share information, communicate, and build connections.

Example: Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn.

Videoconferencing

Technology that allows people to see and talk to each other remotely using video and audio.

Example: Attending an online class using Zoom.

Conversational Mechanisms

The natural ways people manage conversations, such as starting, taking turns, and ending discussions.

Example: Saying “Hi” to start a conversation and “Bye” to end it.

Turn-Taking

The process of people speaking one at a time during a conversation.

Example: One person asks a question, and the other replies.

Conversational Rules

Basic patterns that guide how conversations happen.

Example: A speaker may ask a question to choose who speaks next.

Adjacency Pairs

A pair of related statements in a conversation, where one leads to a predictable response.

Example:

A: "How are you?"

B: "I'm fine."

Back-Channeling

Small verbal or non-verbal signals that show you are listening and understanding.

Example: Saying "uh-huh," nodding, or saying "okay" while someone speaks.

Breakdown in Conversation

When communication fails or is misunderstood.

Example: Mishearing instructions and asking, "What did you say?"

Repair in Conversation

Fixing misunderstandings during communication.

Example: Asking, "Did you mean Monday or Tuesday?"

Social Presence

The feeling that you are interacting with a real person, even through technology.

Example: Feeling connected to someone during a video call.

Telepresence

Technology that makes you feel like you are physically present in another

place.

Example: Attending a meeting remotely using a robot with a camera.

Co-Presence

When people are physically together and interacting in the same space.

Example: Students working together in a classroom.

Coordination Mechanisms

Ways people organize and manage activities together.

Example: Using schedules, rules, or communication to complete a group task.

Awareness Mechanisms

Ways of knowing what others are doing and what is happening around you.

Example: Noticing a colleague speaking or observing activity in a room.

Peripheral Awareness

Being aware of things happening around you without directly focusing on them.

Example: Hearing someone talking nearby while working.

Situational Awareness

Understanding what is happening around you and how it affects your actions.

Example: A doctor monitoring a patient's condition during surgery.

Online Collaboration

Working together with others using digital tools, even when not physically present.

Example: Editing a document together on Google Docs.

Chatbots

Computer programs that simulate conversation with users.

Example: A website chatbot that answers customer questions.

Conversational User Interface (CUI)

A system that allows users to interact using natural language (text or voice).

Example: Talking to a virtual assistant like Alexa.

Zoom Fatigue

Tiredness caused by long periods of video meetings.

Example: Feeling exhausted after several online classes or meetings.

Metaverse

A virtual digital world where people interact using avatars.

Example: Socializing in a 3D virtual environment like Second Life.

Avatar

A digital representation of a person in a virtual environment.

Example: A character you control in a virtual world.

Telepresence Robot

A robot that allows a person to see, hear, and interact remotely.

Example: A student attending class through a robot.

Sharable Interfaces

Digital surfaces that multiple people can use together at the same time.

Example: Interactive whiteboards or touchscreen tables.

Social Games

Games designed to encourage interaction between players.

Example: Board games or multiplayer video games like Minecraft.

Synchronous Interaction

Communication that happens in real time.

Example: Live video calls or chats.

Asynchronous Interaction

Communication that does not happen at the same time.

Example: Emails or discussion forums.

Strong Ties

Close relationships with deep connections.

Example: Family and close friends.

Weak Ties

Casual or less close relationships.

Example: Acquaintances or colleagues.